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Automatic testing of home entertainment automation systems for controlling connected devices

Abstract

Methods, systems, and apparatuses are described for testing communication with a device. A multimedia receiver may be communicatively coupled to a media device, such as a source media device. The multimedia receiver may transmit a test command to control the source media device using a communication protocol. A video frame output by the source media device may be obtained. Based at least on the video frame, it may be determined whether the source media device received the test command. In response to a determination that the source media device received the test command, an indication may be stored that the source media device may be controlled using the communication protocol.

Inventors: Marino; Nino V. (Alameda, CA), Satheesh; Sharath H. (Bangalore, IN), Aggarwal; Ashish D. (Stevenson Ranch, CA), Khandelwal; Shivam (Jaipur, IN), Mittal; Neha (Bangalore, IN)

Applicant: Caavo Inc (Milpitas, CA)

Family ID: 68764393

Assignee: Caavo Inc (Milpitas, CA)

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/148,067, filed on Jan. 13, 2021, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,716,458, issued on Aug. 1, 2023, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/548,343, filed on Aug. 22, 2019, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,095,875, issued one Aug. 17, 2021, which is a continuation-in-part of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/219,342, filed on Dec. 13, 2018, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,044,352, issued on Jun. 22, 2021, which claims foreign priority to Indian Patent Application number 201741045277, filed on Dec. 16, 2017, the entireties of which are incorporated by reference herein. This application also claims foreign priority to Indian Patent Application number 201841031558, filed on Aug. 23, 2018, the entirety of which is incorporated by reference herein.

BACKGROUND

Technical Field

(1) The subject matter described herein relates to automatic testing of home entertainment automation systems for controlling connected devices using one or more communication protocols.

Description of Related Art

(2) An entertainment system may comprise several audio/video (AV) devices connected to a television (TV) or high definition TV (HDTV). These devices may include, for example, a cable/satellite TV set top box (STB), an audio system, a Blu-ray® or DVD (digital versatile disc) player, a digital media adapter, a game console, a multimedia streaming device, etc. Each of these types of devices are typically controlled by a remote control, such as an infrared (IR) and a radio-frequency (RF) remote control. However, the selection of which remote-control device to use is generally determined manually by a user (e.g., by selecting a particular remote control or device to communicate with the media device). Given the ever-growing number of devices in a living room, the number of remote-control devices that a user needs to operate can be expected to grow proportionately to the number of devices the user has in a given home entertainment setup.

(3) In order to simplify the control of all these devices, a Home Automation Control System is typically used (e.g., Control4®, Logitech Harmony®, etc.), which provides the user a single point control device, such as a hand held remote, a tablet or a computer. While such a system may ease the use of a home entertainment system, setting up this type of system is often a time consuming and complex process. In some instances, a professional installer or home entertainment system expert may be needed. Even with the burdensome setup process, the difficulty of ensuring that the control system can control each device successfully still remains.

BRIEF SUMMARY

(4) This Summary is provided to introduce a selection of concepts in a simplified form that are further described below in the Detailed Description. This Summary is not intended to identify key features or essential features of the claimed subject matter, nor is it intended to be used to limit the scope of the claimed subject matter.

(5) Methods, systems, and apparatuses are described for testing communication with a device. A multimedia receiver may be communicatively coupled to a media device, such as a source media device. The multimedia receiver may transmit a test command to control the source media device using a communication protocol. A video frame output by the source media device may be obtained. Based at least on the video frame, it may be determined whether the source media device

received the test command. In response to a determination that the source media device received the test command, an indication may be stored that the source media device may be controlled using the communication protocol.

(6) In a further implementation, methods, systems, and apparatuses are provided for determining the identity of a particular device available on a network that is coupled to a multimedia switch. One or more source media devices available on a network are identified. For each of the source media devices, a corresponding test command may be transmitted over the network to control the device. A video frame output by one of the source media devices is obtained, and based on the video frame, it is determined that the source media device from which the video frame was obtained received the corresponding test command. In response, the device identifier and an indication that the source media device can be controlled using one or more of communication protocols (e.g., Internet Protocol (IP), RF, IR, High-Definition Multimedia Interface Consumer Electronics Control (HDMI-CEC), etc.) may be stored.

(7) Further features and advantages, as well as the structure and operation of various examples, are described in detail below with reference to the accompanying drawings. It is noted that the ideas and techniques are not limited to the specific examples described herein. Such examples are presented herein for illustrative purposes only. Additional examples will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) based on the teachings contained herein.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS/FIGURES

- (1) The accompanying drawings, which are incorporated herein and form a part of the specification, illustrate embodiments and, together with the description, further serve to explain the principles of the embodiments and to enable a person skilled in the pertinent art to make and use the embodiments.
- (2) FIG. 1 depicts a block diagram of an exemplary multimedia receiver in accordance with embodiments described herein.
- (3) FIG. 2 is a flowchart of a method for determining whether a source media device received a test command, according to an example embodiment.
- (4) FIG. 3 is a block diagram of a system comprising logic for automatically testing the control of a device, according to an example embodiment.
- (5) FIG. 4 is a flowchart of a method for transmitting a test command based on a device state, according to an example embodiment.
- (6) FIG. 5 is a flowchart of a method for determining whether a source media device received a test command based on a video frame, according to an example embodiment.
- (7) FIG. 6 is a flowchart of a method for transmitting test commands to one or more devices available on a network, according to an example embodiment.
- (8) FIG. 7 is a flowchart of a method for automatically pairing with a media device, according to an example embodiment.
- (9) FIG. 8 is a block diagram of an example computer system in which embodiments may be implemented.
- (10) Embodiments will now be described with reference to the accompanying drawings. In the drawings, like reference numbers indicate identical or functionally similar elements. Additionally, the left-most digit(s) of a reference number identifies the drawing in which the reference number first appears.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

I. Introduction

- (11) The present specification discloses numerous example embodiments. The scope of the present

patent application is not limited to the disclosed embodiments, but also encompasses combinations of the disclosed embodiments, as well as modifications to the disclosed embodiments.

(12) References in the specification to “one embodiment,” “an embodiment,” “an example embodiment,” etc., indicate that the embodiment described may include a particular feature, structure, or characteristic, but every embodiment may not necessarily include the particular feature, structure, or characteristic. Moreover, such phrases are not necessarily referring to the same embodiment. Further, when a particular feature, structure, or characteristic is described in connection with an embodiment, it is submitted that it is within the knowledge of one skilled in the art to effect such feature, structure, or characteristic in connection with other embodiments whether or not explicitly described.

(13) Furthermore, it should be understood that spatial descriptions (e.g., “above,” “below,” “up,” “left,” “right,” “down,” “top,” “bottom,” “vertical,” “horizontal,” “front,” “rear,” etc.) used herein are for purposes of illustration only, and that practical implementations of the structures described herein can be spatially arranged in any orientation or manner.

(14) Numerous exemplary embodiments are described as follows. It is noted that the section/subsection headings used herein are not intended to be limiting. Embodiments described in this document may be eligible for inclusion within multiple different sections or subsections. Furthermore, disclosed embodiments may be combined with each other in any manner.

II. Example Embodiments

(15) An entertainment system may comprise several audio/video (AV) devices connected to a television (TV) or high definition TV (HDTV). These devices may include, for example, a cable/satellite TV set top box (STB), an audio system, a Blu-ray® or DVD (digital versatile disc) player, a digital media adapter, a game console, a multimedia streaming device, etc. Each of these types of devices are typically controlled by a remote control, such as an infrared (IR) and a radio-frequency (RF) remote control. However, the selection of which of remote-control device to use is generally determined manually by a user (e.g., by selecting a particular remote control or device to communicate with the media device). Given the ever-growing number of devices in a living room, the number of remote-control devices that a user needs to operate can be expected to grow proportionately to the number of devices the user has in a given home entertainment setup.

(16) In order to simplify the control of all these devices, a Home Automation Control System is typically used (e.g., Control4®, Logitech Harmony®, etc.), which provides the user a single point control device, such as a hand held remote, a tablet or a computer. While such a system may ease the use of a home entertainment system, setting up this type of system is often a time consuming and complex process. In some instances, a professional installer or home entertainment system expert may be needed. Even with the burdensome setup process, the difficulty of ensuring that the control system can control each device successfully still remains.

(17) Techniques are described herein to automatically determine whether a device, such as a source media device, connected to a multimedia receiver may be controlled using one or more communication protocols. For instance, the multimedia receiver may comprise a home entertainment control system, such as a hub, a multimedia switching device, an audio/video receiver (AVR), etc. The control system may have a plurality of devices connected to it, such as a source media device (e.g., a media streaming device, a set-top box (STB), etc.) and a sink media device (e.g., a television (TV), projector, etc.). In implementations, audio/video (AV) content provided by a source media device may be received by the multimedia receiver, and transmitted for playback on a sink device, such as a TV or a projector. In some further examples, functionality described herein may also be implemented in the sink device itself.

(18) In accordance with embodiments, a test command may be transmitted from a multimedia receiver to a source media device using one or more communication protocols (e.g., using IR, RF, High-Definition Multimedia Interface Consumer Electronics Control (HDMI-CEC), and/or Internet Protocol (IP)). The test command may include any type of control operation, such as a navigation

command, selecting a particular icon or item of content, launching an application, launching a guide, launching a menu or other predetermined graphical user interface (GUI) screen, etc. Since the multimedia receiver receives the AV signals from source media device to which it is connected, the multimedia receiver may analyze one or more video frames (e.g., images representing the current output of the source media device) to determine whether the test command was received by the media device and successfully applied. In implementations, if the multimedia receiver verifies that the media device received the test command, the media device can be categorized as a device controllable using the communication protocol (e.g., by storing an indication in a storage).

(19) In some implementations, the multimedia receiver may browse a network to identify one or more source media devices available on the network (such as a local area network). The multimedia receiver may transmit a command, such as a unique command, using a network-based communication protocol to each of the detected media devices and determine, based on a video frame received from one of the source media devices, which of the source media devices is coupled to the multimedia receiver. Based on such a determination, the source media device connected to control system may be identified (e.g., based on its network address) and categorized as controllable using the network-based communication protocol.

(20) Thus, in accordance with implementations described herein, a multimedia receiver may automatically identify and test whether source media devices coupled to the multimedia receiver may be controlled using various communication protocols. Furthermore, the user need not confirm whether the source media device responded appropriately because verification may be automatically performed by analyzing content on a video frame obtained from the source media device. As a result, testing of various communication protocols may be carried out with minimal user involvement, enabling subsequent control of devices coupled to the multimedia switch to be carried out in a dynamic fashion.

III. Automatic Control Test of a Media Device

(21) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of a system **100** that is configured to automatically perform a control test to determine whether a multimedia receiver can control an electronic device, in accordance with an embodiment. As shown in FIG. 1, system **100** includes one or more electronic device(s) **102**, a multimedia receiver **104**, and a control device **128**.

(22) In the illustrative example shown in FIG. 1, electronic device(s) **102** may be source media devices configured to provide audio and/or video signals (e.g., multimedia content). Electronic device(s) **102** may also include sink devices configured to receive audio and/or video signals for playback. For instance, electronic device(s) **102** may be a Blu-ray player, a STB, a streaming media player, a TV, and/or a projector. The types of electronic devices are only illustrative, and electronic device(s) **102** may be any electronic device capable of providing and/or playing back AV signals.

(23) As shown in FIG. 1, multimedia receiver **104** includes AV port(s) **110**, a switch circuit **106**, control logic **112**, automatic control testing logic **114**, a network interface **116**, a storage **118**, a device control mapping **120**, a receiver **122**, an IR transmitter **124**, and an RF transmitter **126**. As further shown in FIG. 1, electronic device(s) **102** are coupled to AV port(s) **110**. In embodiments, electronic device(s) **102** may be coupled to AV port(s) **110** via a High-Definition Multimedia Interface (HDMI) cable **108**. Port(s) **110** may be further configured to transmit a control signal **108A** to electronic device(s) **102** using an HDMI-CEC communication protocol. Although it is described herein that control signal **108A** may be transmitted using an HDMI-CEC communication protocol, it is understood that control signal **108A** may include any other suitable transmission using the HDMI cable interface, or any other signaling protocol available with other types of audio/video interfaces. AV port(s) **110** may be automatically configured to be source AV ports or sink AV ports upon connecting electronic device(s) **102** to AV port(s) **110**.

(24) Although one or more devices illustrated in FIG. 1 may be coupled via HDMI interface in an illustrative arrangement, other interfaces are also contemplated for transmission of AV content, including but not limited to a video graphics array (VGA) cable, a universal serial bus (USB) cable,

digital video interface (DVI) cable, a DisplayPort interface, a component video interface, a composite video interface, and a coaxial video interface.

(25) Although embodiments described herein are illustrated as part of a multimedia receiver (which may include, but is not limited to a home entertainment control system, such as a hub, a multimedia switching device, an AVR, a TV, a projector, etc.), it is understood that implementations described herein are not intended to be limited to the illustrative systems shown. For instance, the illustrative systems of FIG. 1 and/or FIG. 3 (described below) may comprise any combination of components, any number of electronic devices (e.g., media devices), and may be coupled in any suitable manner (e.g., such as AV interfaces other than an HDMI interface, including one or more intermediate devices such as an AVR, etc.). Furthermore, it is understood and appreciated that any other device that may transmit test commands to another electronic device may implement the techniques described. For example, any one or more of AV port(s) **110**, switch circuit **106**, control logic **112**, automatic control testing logic **114**, network interface **116**, storage **118**, device control mapping **120**, receiver **122**, IR transmitter **124**, and RF transmitter **126** may be implemented in a remote control (e.g., a universal remote control), a smartphone, a tablet, a computer, or any other device that can communicate or control another electronic device using one or more communication protocols.

(26) Switch circuit **106** may be configured to connect a particular source AV port (e.g., one of AV port(s) **110**) to a particular one or more sink AV ports (e.g., another one of AV port(s) **110**) based, for instance, on a user command (e.g., received as voice command **130** or via control device **128**). Additional details regarding the auto-configuration of AV port(s) may be found in U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/945,079, filed on Nov. 18, 2015 and entitled “Auto Detection and Adaptive Configuration of HDMI Ports,” the entirety of which is incorporated by reference. Furthermore, additional details regarding the identification of electronic device(s) and the mapping of electronic device(s) to AV port(s) may be found in U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/945,125, filed on Nov. 18, 2015 and entitled “Automatic Identification and Mapping of Consumer Electronic Devices to Ports on an HDMI Switch,” the entirety of which is incorporated by reference.

(27) Receiver **122** comprise a receiver configured to receive one or more command(s) that indicate that a user would like to use one or more of electronic device(s) **102** for providing and/or presenting content. For example, receiver **122** may be configured to receive such command(s) from control device **128** (or any other control devices not shown in FIG. 1) or voice command **130**.

(28) In accordance with an embodiment, control device **128** may be operable to transmit a request to control any one or more of electronic device(s) **102** by transmitting a control signal **128A**. The control signals may be transmitted via a wired connection (e.g., via a Universal Serial Bus (USB) cable, a coaxial cable, etc.). In accordance with another embodiment, the control signals are transmitted via a wireless connection (e.g., via infrared (IR) communication, radio frequency (RF) communication (e.g., Bluetooth™, as described in the various standards developed and licensed by the Bluetooth™ Special Interest Group, technologies such as ZigBee® that are based on the IEEE 802.15.4 standard for wireless personal area networks, near field communication (NFC), other RF-based or internet protocol (IP)-based communication technologies such as any of the well-known IEEE 802.11 protocols, etc.) and/or the like.

(29) Control device **128** may be a remote-control device, a desktop computer, a mobile device, such as a telephone (e.g., a smart phone and/or mobile phone), a personal data assistance (PDA), a tablet, a laptop, etc. Control device **128** may be a dedicated remote-control device including smart features such as those typically associated with a smart phone (e.g., the capability to access the Internet and/or execute variety of different software applications), but without the capability of communicating via a cellular network.

(30) A user may use control device **128** to select a source device and/or a sink device that the user would like to use for providing and/or presenting content. After making a selection, control device **128** may transmit a command **128A** to receiver **122** that includes an identifier of the selected source

and/or sink devices. The identifier may include, but is not limited to, the type of the electronic device (e.g., a Blu-ray player, a DVD player, a set-top box, a streaming media player, a TV, a projector etc.), a brand name of the electronic device, a manufacturer of the electronic device, a model number of the electronic device, and/or the like. In an embodiment, control device **128** may also identify a particular command to be carried out on one or more of electronic device(s) **102**, such as a command to power on a device, switch an input of a device, adjust a volume of a device, launch an application and/or multimedia content on a device, etc.

(31) Receiver **122** may also be configured to receive one or more voice commands **130** from a user that identify electronic device(s) (e.g., electronic device(s) **102**) a user would like to use for providing and/or presenting content. For example, the user may utter one or more commands or phrases that specify electronic device(s) that the user would like to use (e.g., “Watch DVD,” “Watch satellite TV using projector,” “Turn on streaming media device”). The command(s) may identify electronic device(s) by one or more of the following: a type of the electronic device, a brand name of the electronic device, a manufacturer of the electronic device, a model number of the electronic device and/or the like. In accordance with an embodiment, receiver **122** may comprise a microphone configured to capture audio signals. In such an embodiment, receiver **122** and/or another component of multimedia receiver **104** is configured to analyze audio signals to detect voice commands included therein. It is noted and understood that receiver **122** may comprise any number of signal receivers, such as one or more separate receivers for each communication protocol associated with control device **128**, and/or one or more combined receivers configured to receive signals using a plurality of communication protocols.

(32) A microphone may be included in control device **128**. In accordance with such an embodiment, control device **128** is configured to analyze the audio signal received by the microphone to detect voice command(s) included therein, identify the electronic device(s) specified by the user, and/or transmit command(s) including identifiers for the identified electronic device(s) to receiver **122**. After receiving such command(s), receiver provides the identifier(s) included therein to a mapping component (not shown) in control logic **112**. Based on the identifier(s) in the mapping component, control logic **112** may be configured to provide a control signal to switch circuit **106**, which causes switch circuit **106** to connect the identified source AV port to the identified and/or determined sink AV port.

(33) Multimedia receiver **104** may be configured to transmit a control signal to any of electronic device(s) **102**. The control signal may be any type of signal to control one or more electronic device(s) **102**, such as a signal to control a power state, an input, an output, an audio setting, a video setting, a navigation, a menu, a guide, launching of applications or multimedia content, or any other setting of electronic device(s) **102**. In embodiments, electronic device(s) **102** may be configured to receive control signals using any one or more communication protocols. For example, as shown in FIG. 1, multimedia receiver **104** may transmit to electronic device(s) **102** an IP control signal **116A** via a network interface **116**, an IR control signal **124A** via an IR transmitter **124**, an RF control signal **126A** via an RF transmitter **126**, and/or a HDMI-CEC control signal **108A** via an HDMI interface **108**.

(34) Network interface **116** is configured to enable multimedia receiver **104** to communicate with one or more other devices (e.g., electronic device(s) **102**) via a network, such as a local area network (LAN), wide area network (WAN), an ethernet, and/or other networks, such as the Internet. In accordance with embodiments, network interface **116** may transmit an IP control signal **116A** over the network to control one or more functions of electronic device(s) **102**. Network interface **116** may include any suitable type of interface, such as a wired and/or wireless interfaces. In embodiments, network interface **116** may further enable multimedia receiver **104** to engage in two-way communication with one or more remote (e.g., cloud-based) systems (not shown). For instance, a remote system, such as a cloud-based server, may identify one or more communication protocols that may be used for communication with electronic device(s) **102**, and/or particular

commands suitable for communication with the electronic device(s) using the one or more communication protocols.

(35) IR transmitter **124** may transmit an IR control signal **124A** using any suitable IR protocol known and understood to those skilled in the art. For instance, IR transmitter **124** may transmit an IR control signal **124A** to be received by a suitable IR receiver of the receiving electronic device. In some examples, IR control signal **124A** may be transmitted via one or more repeaters or IR signal blasters (not shown), such as a line-of-sight is not present between receiver **122** and the receiving electronic device (e.g., where a device may be behind a physical obstruction, such as in a cabinet or a closet).

(36) RF transmitter **126** may transmit an RF control signal via any suitable type of RF communication (e.g., Bluetooth™, as described in the various standards developed and licensed by the Bluetooth™ Special Interest Group, technologies such as ZigBee® that are based on the IEEE 802.15.4 standard for wireless personal area networks, near field communication (NFC), other RF-based or internet protocol (IP)-based communication technologies such as any of the well-known IEEE 802.11 protocols, etc.), and/or the like.

(37) Control logic **112** may include automatic control testing logic **114** configured to automatically test whether multimedia receiver **104** may communicate successfully with one or more electronic device(s) **102** using one or more communication protocols, including an IR communication protocol, an RF communication protocol, an IP communication protocol, and/or an HDMI-CEC communication protocol. In embodiments, automatic control testing logic **114** may be configured to transmit test commands using a plurality of communication protocols and store an indication of each communication protocol for each device that was successful and/or unsuccessful.

(38) In some further embodiments, automatic control testing logic **114** may be configured to browse for media devices available on a network and automatically determine which of the media devices is coupled to multimedia receiver **104** (e.g., via HDMI cable **108** or any other suitable AV interface). For instance, automatic control testing logic may locate a plurality of media devices available on the network, transmit a test command to each of the devices, and analyze an AV signal received by multimedia receiver **104** to determine which of the media devices on the network received a corresponding test command. Based on the determination, multimedia receiver **104** may determine the identity of the device coupled to multimedia receiver **104**, and store identifying information (e.g., a network address) that may be used for subsequent communications with the device.

(39) Storage **118** may be one or more of any storage device described herein, such as, but not limited to, those described below with respect to FIG. 8. Storage **118** may include device control mapping **120**, which may comprise, for instance, one or more indications regarding whether electronic device(s) may be controlled using one or more communication protocols. Device control mapping **120** may include a data structure (e.g., a table/database, or the like) containing one or more entries or other indications identifying whether multimedia receiver **104** verified that the electronic device successfully received and applied a test command from multimedia receiver **104** using one or more communication protocols. In some further examples, device control mapping **120** may also identify an address (e.g., a network address) of the electronic device through which controls may be carried out.

(40) Therefore, in implementations, device control mapping **120** may indicate that multimedia receiver **104** can control a particular electronic device using certain protocols (e.g., IR and IP-based communications in an illustration). In a further embodiment, device control mapping **120** may also identify, for a particular electronic device, individual command types (e.g., a power command, a standby wake-up command, etc.) that may be successfully transmitted to the electronic device using each communication protocol tested. For example, device control mapping **120** may indicate that certain command types may be transmitted using a particular communication protocol, while other command types may not be transmitted (or not transmitted effectively) using the same

communication protocol.

(41) Accordingly, in implementations, automatically testing communication with a media device may be carried out in various ways. For example, FIG. 2 depicts a flowchart **200** of a method for determining whether a source media device received a test command, according to an example embodiment. In an implementation, the method of flowchart **200** may be implemented by automatic control testing logic **114**. For illustrative purposes, flowchart **200** and automatic control testing logic **114** are also described with respect to FIG. 3. FIG. 3 shows a block diagram of a system **300** comprising logic for automatically testing the control of a device, according to an example embodiment. As shown in FIG. 3, system **300** includes one or more sink media device(s) **302A**, one or more source media devices **302B**, and a multimedia receiver **104**. Multimedia receiver **104** of FIG. 3 is an example implementation of multimedia receiver **104** of FIG. 1. Multimedia receiver **104** includes an example implementation of automatic control testing logic **114**, storage **118**, and communicators **314**. Automatic control testing logic **114** includes a test command initiator **304**, a video frame capturer **306**, and a test command verifier **308**. Test command initiator **304** includes a device state determiner and a network browser **312**. As shown in FIG. 3, communicators **314** comprises a plurality of controllers, including an IP controller **316**, an RF controller **318**, an HDMI-CEC controller **320**, and an IR controller **322**. Other structural and operational embodiments will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) based on the discussion regarding flowchart **200** and the system of FIGS. 1 and 3.

(42) As shown in FIG. 2, the method of flowchart **200** begins at step **202**. In step **202**, a test command to control a source media device is transmitted using a communication protocol. For instance, with respect to FIG. 3, automatic control testing logic **114** may cause a test command to be transmitted to one of source media device(s) **302B** using one or more communicators **314**. Source media device(s) **302B** may include any type of media device configured to provide audio and/or video content, which may be presented on one or more sink media device(s) **302A**. In implementations, sink media device(s) **302A** and source media device(s) **302B** are examples of electronic device(s) **102** described with respect to FIG. 1. Sink media device(s) **302A** may be coupled to multimedia receiver **104** via one or more suitable audio/video interfaces **324**, and source media device(s) **302B** may be coupled to multimedia receiver **104** via one or more audio/video interfaces **326** as described herein, including but not limited to one or more HDMI interfaces as described with respect to element **108** of FIG. 1. Furthermore, multimedia receiver **104** and one or more of sink media device(s) **302A** and source media device(s) **302B** may communicate with each other using one or more communication protocols **324A** and **326A**, respectively, as described herein. Such communication protocols include, but are not limited to, an IR communication protocol, RF communication protocol, IP communication protocol, and/or HDMI-CEC communication protocol.

(43) As shown in FIG. 3, test command initiator **304** may be configured to initiate testing of source media device(s) **302B**. For instance, test command initiator **304** may transmit a signal to communicators **314** to transmit a test command to control one or more of the source media devices using one or more communication protocols. In examples, test command initiator and/or communicators **314** may cause any one or more of IP controller **316**, RF controller **318**, HDMI-CEC controller **320**, or IR controller **322** to transmit a test command using the corresponding communication protocol. For instance, IP controller **316** may cause a test command to be transmitted to a source media device via network interface **116** (e.g., via an IP network), RF controller **318** may cause a test command to be transmitted to a source media device using RF transmitter **126**, HDMI-CEC controller **320** may cause a test command to be transmitted to a source media device via HDMI-CEC signal **108A**, and IR controller **322** may cause a test command to be transmitted to a source media device using IR transmitter **124**.

(44) In implementations, a test command may be a command determined by automatic control testing logic **114** for testing communication with a source media device. For instance, a test

command may be a predetermined type of command for a particular device, or even a plurality of types of commands for a device. In some implementations, a test command may comprise one or more commands that may be used to verify successful control of a device, such that when communication of the test command are successfully applied on a source media device using a particular communication protocol, it may be inferred that the multimedia receiver **104** may communicate the test command and/or one or more additional commands not tested with the source media device using the same communication protocol. For instance, if a particular test command is successfully received by a device using an IR communication protocol, it may be inferred that a clear line of sight exists between the IR transmitter and the source device sufficient for IR transmissions, thereby eliminating the need for further testing of IR commands in some instances.

(45) A test command may include any type of control operation on source media device(s) **302B**, including but not limited to navigation commands, content playback commands (e.g., play, pause, fast forward, rewind, stop, etc.), launching applications, games, interfaces, content, menus, guides, etc. In some instances, a test command may comprise a series or sequence of commands (e.g., a plurality of navigation commands), such as a sequence of commands to navigate through a series of GUI screens and selecting a particular object.

(46) For instance, IR controller **322** may cause IR transmitter **124** to transmit any one or more IR-based commands to source media device(s) **302B** to test IR communications. IR-based test commands may include navigation commands (e.g., navigate up, down, left, right, selecting an element, navigating to a previous screen, etc.), content playback commands, launching certain screens or interfaces within source media device(s) **302B** (e.g., launching a guide on a set-top box, accessing a list of pre-recorded programs, accessing a home screen, etc.) and/or searching for content. In implementations, IR transmitter **124** may be configured to transmit IR commands using an IR code associated with the device to which an IR test command is being transmitted. A mapping of such IR codes to media devices may be stored locally on multimedia receiver **104** and/or accessed from a remotely located storage via network interface **116**.

(47) RF controller **318** may cause RF transmitter **126** to transmit a test command using any RF-based communication protocol described herein. In some implementations, RF transmitter **126** may include a transmitter for transmitting a test command via a Bluetooth™ protocol. Examples of Bluetooth™ capable devices include, but are not limited to Amazon FireTV, Nvidia Shield, Sony Playstation 3, Sony Playstation 4, etc. Test commands transmitted by RF transmitter **126** may similarly include navigation commands and/or playback commands as described herein. In some implementations, RF-based commands may comprise commands to navigate to certain screens or interfaces, such as launching a home screen, a search screen, launching a game or application, or moving between various screens, etc.

(48) IP controller **316** may cause a test command to be transmitted via network interface **116**, such as a local area network. Commands transmitted using network interface **116** may similarly comprise navigation commands as described herein, as well as one or more other commands to navigate to or launch certain screens, interfaces, applications, content, etc. In some implementations, test commands transmitted via network interface **116** may include one or more text strings (e.g., automatically inputting a search string in a search box). For instance, a test command for a source media device that is potentially controllable via network interface **116** may include searching and/or launching a particular item of multimedia content (e.g., a predetermined movie or television show). Commands transmitted via network interface **116** may be transmitted to source media device(s) **302B** based on a network address, such as an IP address or a Media Access Control (MAC) address. As will be described in more detail below with respect to FIG. 6, some implementations enable the automatic identification of a network address for a device coupled to multimedia receiver **104**. Examples of devices that may be controllable via an IP-based command include, but are not limited to a Roku streaming media device, AppleTV, Amazon FireTV, Nvidia Shield, certain set-top boxes, etc.

(49) In some examples, a test command transmitted via network interface **116** may comprise an image or a video to be presented or casted on one of sink media device(s) **302A**. For instance, test command initiator **304** may be configured to cause IP controller **316** to transmit a known or predetermined image or video to be casted from source media device(s) **302B** via network interface **126**. For instance, in response to receiving a test command to cast the image or video, source media device(s) **302B** may output, to multimedia receiver **104** via the appropriate AV interface, the image or video transmitted by test command initiator **304**. Casting of such an image or video may be performed in accordance with one or more protocols or standards set forth by the Digital Living Network Alliance® (DLNA), one or more wireless-based network casting protocols, or any other known or future-developed for casting an image or video between devices.

(50) HDMI-CEC controller **322** may cause a test command to be transmitted to a source media device via HDMI interface **108** (e.g., using an HDMI-CEC protocol). Test commands transmitted using an HDMI-CEC protocol may similarly comprise one or more commands described previously, including but not limited to operations to power on or power off a device, navigation commands, etc. Source media device(s) **302B** may be configured receive and apply such HDMI-CEC based commands based on an AV.link protocol standardized by the European Committee for Electrotechnical Standardization (CENELEC). HDMI-CEC commands may be transmitted in a single-wire bidirectional serial bus implemented in HDMI interface **108**. It is noted and understood that implementations are not limited to transmitting a test command using an HDMI-CEC protocol as described, but may also include transmitting a test command using any other suitable audio/video signaling interface.

(51) In accordance with some implementations, test command initiator **304** may also identify a brand, make, and/or model of source media device(s) **302B** prior to transmitting a test command. Test command initiator **304** may perform such an identification in any manner, including via an identification by a user and/or automatically. For example, test command initiator **304** may identify a brand, make, and/or model automatically by parsing information (e.g., Extended Display Identification Data, or EDID) in an AV interface, such as HDMI interface **108**, analyzing a video or audio signal from the source media device, or any other manner. Based on such an identification, test command initiator **304** may determine a format and/or type of test command to transmit to source media device(s) **302B**. For instance, if a test command is to be transmitted via IR transmitter **124**, IR signal **124A** may utilize an IR code associated with a brand, make, and/or model of source media device. In such an example, test command initiator **304** may be configured to cause IR controller **322** to automatically program IR transmitter **124** to utilize the appropriate IR code associated with source media device(s) **302B**. In implementations, test command initiator **304** may obtain such a code from a local and/or a remote repository (e.g., accessed via network interface **116**).

(52) Furthermore, test command initiator **304** may determine a type of test command to transmit to source media device(s) **302B** based on a device brand, make, and/or model. For instance, certain media devices may not comprise an RF receiver. In other words, test command initiator **304** may be configured to limit attempted communication with a device based on a list of communication protocols that are known to be supported by the device as well as individual types of test commands that may be applied to each particular device (e.g., launching a guide menu may not be available for certain source media devices). In such an example, test command initiator **304** may transmit test commands using one or more other communication protocols through which the media device may potentially receive test commands (e.g., IR, HDMI-CEC, and/or IP). It is noted and understood, however, that prior knowledge regarding a device's brand, make, and/or model is not required in all implementations. For instance, where a device brand, make, and/or model is unknown, test command initiator **304** may still be configured to automatically attempt to transmit test commands using one or more available communication protocols (e.g., HDMI-CEC).

(53) In step **204**, a video frame output by the source media device is obtained. For instance, with

respect to FIG. 3, video frame capturer **306** may obtain a video frame from one of source media device(s) **302** via a corresponding one of port(s) **110** of multimedia receiver **104**. The obtained video frame may include one or more frames of video content output by the source media device in any format. For instance, the video frame may be in a raw or uncompressed form, such as in a red, green, blue (RGB) image format. In another embodiment, the video frame may be in a YUV image format. In other embodiments, the video frame may be in any other suitable format (compressed or uncompressed), or may extract images corresponding to the format of the video signal received via the appropriate interface (e.g., in a native image format). In other embodiments, the video frame may be obtained in more than one image format (e.g., in both RGB and YUV formats). In some implementations, one or more pre-processing algorithms may be performed on the obtained video image, including but not limited to an image conversion algorithm, a resizing operation, a thresholding operation, and/or a cropping operation.

(54) In step **206**, a determination is made whether the source media device received the test command based at least on the video frame. For example, with reference to FIG. 3, test command verifier **308** may be configured to determine, based at least on the video frame obtained by video frame capturer **306**, whether the source media device to which a test command was transmitted was received (e.g., applied to the source media device to carry out the test command successfully). Test command verifier **308** may determine whether a test command was received by a source media device in various ways. For example, test command verifier **308** may analyze the content of the obtained video frame to determine whether the video frame corresponds to an expected result. In other words, based on the type of test command transmitted to the source media device, test command verifier **308** may analyze the obtained video frame following transmission of the test command to determine whether the source media device reacted consistent with application of the test command (e.g., navigated to a certain page, launched a particular item of content, casted an image, or any other types of test commands described herein). Example techniques for determining whether a source media device received a test command are described in greater detail below with respect to FIG. 5.

(55) In this manner, test command verifier **308** may automatically verify whether a transmitted command has been received and successfully applied on source media device(s) **302B**. Additional details regarding automatically analyzing video content output by an electronic device may be found in U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/819,896, filed on Nov. 21, 2017 and entitled "Automatic Screen Navigation for Media Device Configuration and Control," the entirety of which is incorporated by reference. It is also noted and understood that implementations are not limited to obtaining video frames, but may also encompass obtaining and/or analyzing a still image and/or an audio signal.

(56) In some example embodiments, if test command verifier **308** determines that the test command has not been received and/or successfully applied to the source media device, test command initiator **304** may attempt to retry the communication by transmitting the same test command, transmitting a different test command, altering a characteristic of the transmission (e.g., transmitting a test command using a different IR code), and/or providing an indication or notification to a user. For instance, a user notification may prompt the user via one of sink media devices **302A** to verify aspects of the user's system configuration, such as verifying that a network cable is plugged in to various components of the system, a HDMI cable is appropriately coupling the media device and the multimedia receiver, no physical obstruction is blocking an IR transmitter's line of sight, one or more devices are powered on, etc.

(57) In step **208**, in response to determining that the source media device received the test command, an indication that the source media device can be controlled using the communication protocol is stored. For instance, with continued reference to FIG. 3, test command verifier **308** may store an indication in device control mapping **120** that one of source media device(s) **302B** was successfully controlled using a particular communication protocol in response to a test command

transmitted to the device using the protocol. For example, device control mapping **120** comprise an indication that test command verifier **308** verified the successful transmission and application of a test command to a particular one of source media device(s) **302B** using a particular communication protocol. In embodiments, device control mapping **120** may be stored locally on multimedia receiver **104**, or may be stored remotely (e.g., on a cloud-based server).

(58) Device control mapping **120** may comprise any suitable structure, including but not limited to a database, table, listing, etc. that may associate a device and one or more tested communication protocols. For instance, device control mapping **120** may identify, for each device tested, the device name, a device identifier (e.g., a model number, serial number, and/or any other identifying information), each communication supported by the device, and an indication whether communication was verified using the communication protocol. In some implementations, device control mapping **120** may also be configured to identify a device address via which communications between multimedia receiver **104** and the device may be carried out, such as an IP address, a MAC address, a logical address (e.g., for communications using the HDMI-CEC protocol), a device key (e.g., a primary key for communications using Bluetooth communications), etc. In some other implementations, device control mapping **120** may also identify a code, such as an IR code, that was successfully tested to communicate with a device.

(59) It is also noted that automatic control testing logic **114** may be configured to perform an automatic control test for one or more source media device(s) **302B** for a plurality of different communication protocols. In other words, test command verifier **308** may be configured to verify, for a particular source media device, whether the multimedia receiver **104** was able to successfully transmit a test command to the source media device using various protocols (e.g., IR, IP, RF, and/or HDMI-CEC). In such examples, automatic control testing logic **114** may be configured to perform a first automatic control test for a particular source media device using a first communication protocol, and upon completion of the first test, perform a second automatic control test for the same source media device using a second communication protocol, and so on until each communication protocol has been tested (or it has been determined that certain protocols need not be tested where the source media device does not support communications using such a protocol).

(60) Therefore, in implementations, test command initiator **304** may cause communicators **314** to transmit a plurality of test commands to control the source media device, each test command being transmitted using a different communication protocol. For each of the plurality of test commands transmitted, video frame capturer **306** may obtain a video frame from the source media device following transmission of the test command. Test command verifier **308** may determine, for each test command, whether the source media device responded to the test command, and in response to the determination, store an indication that the source media device can be (and/or cannot be) controlled using the communication protocol corresponding to the test command.

(61) Accordingly, in implementations, a list, mapping, or other categorization may be generated that identifies which communication protocols may be used to successfully transmit commands to control each source media device. For example, even if a particular source media device supports a communication protocol (e.g., IR-based commands), if the device is located behind an obstruction, such as located within a closet, IR signals may not be received. In such a scenario, automatic control testing logic **114** may determine that IR-based commands are not suitable for transmission to the particular device and/or store such an indication in device control mapping **120**. During operation of the source media device, multimedia receiver **104** may rely on other communication protocols that may have been successfully verified for the device (e.g., RF and/or IP-based transmissions) and stored in device control mapping **120**. In other words, where receiver **122** receives a request to perform an action executable on one of source media device(s) **302B**, a particular one of communicators **314** (based at least on device control mapping **120** that identifies, among other things, which communication protocols were verified to work with the source media device) may be selected to transmit an operation command corresponding to the request. In this

manner, multimedia receiver **104** not only may be configured to automatically determine which protocols have been confirmed to work for a particular device, multimedia receiver **104** may also be configured to automatically carry out subsequent controls of the device during user operation based on such testing.

(62) In some further implementations, device control mapping **120** may also comprise one or more different command types that may be communicated using each of the communication protocols. As an illustrative example, device control mapping **120** may indicate that a power command was successfully verified with a Roku® streaming media device using an IR or RF communication protocol, but not with another protocol (e.g., an IP-based communication protocol). In this manner, device control mapping **120** may not only identify which communication protocols were verified to work with a particular device, but also individual test commands that were verified to work (or not work).

(63) Accordingly, device control mapping **120** may indicate whether multimedia receiver **104** may communicate with source media device(s) **102B** using any one or more of an HDMI-CEC control signal **108A**, an IP control signal **116A**, an IR control signal **124A**, and/or an RF control signal **126A**. In this manner, device control mapping **120** may comprise a categorization or association between each source media device and its ability to be successfully controlled by one or more communication protocols. Using such a categorization, multimedia receiver **104** may determine which one (or more) communication protocols to utilize during actual operation of the source media device to ensure a successful control operation and/or enhance a user experience.

(64) For example, implementations described herein may also enable a real-time verification of commands transmitted to a media device during user operation (i.e., not during testing). For instance, if multimedia receiver **104** transmits a command to a set-top box to change a channel but the set-top box failed to respond, multimedia receiver **104** may determine, by analyzing one or more video frames, that the set-top box did not receive or apply the command successfully. In such a scenario, multimedia receiver **104** may be configured to automatically re-transmit the command using the same communication protocol or optionally re-transmit the command using one or more other protocols for which testing has previously been performed in accordance with implementations described herein.

(65) In some implementations, automatic control testing may be performed automatically and/or without user involvement. For instance, FIG. 4 is a flowchart of a method for transmitting a test command based on a device state, according to an example embodiment. For illustrative purposes, FIG. 4 will be described with continued reference to systems **100** and **300** of FIGS. 1 and 3, respectively. Other structural and operational embodiments will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) based on the discussion regarding flowchart **400** and the systems of FIGS. 1 and 3. Flowchart **400** and systems **100** and **300** are described in further detail as follows.

(66) Flowchart **400** begins with step **402**. In step **402**, it is determined that the source media device is not providing video content for display on a sink device. For instance, with reference to FIG. 3, device state determiner **310** may be configured to determine a state of a source media device. In one example, device state determiner **310** may be configured to determine that a source media device (e.g., one of source media device(s) **302B**) is not providing video content for display on a sink device (one of sink media device(s) **302B**). Device state determiner **310** may determine a state of a device in various ways.

(67) In one implementation, device state determiner **310** may obtain a video frame from video frame capturer **306** to determine that one of source media device(s) **302B** is not presently providing video content for presentation on a sink device. Such a determination may be made, for instance, by analyzing the video frame to determine that the source media device is in a sleep or other non-activity state. In other implementations, such a determination may be made if a certain time has elapsed without the content of video frames captured by video frame capturer **306** changing. In yet other examples, device state determiner **310** may determine that a source media device is not

providing content for playback on a sink device by determining that the device is not presently powered on (e.g., video frames are not being received from the device). In this manner, device state determiner **310** may determine that a particular source media device is not being used.

(68) In step **404**, the test command to control the source media device is transmitted in response to the determination that the source media device is not providing video content for display on the sink device. For instance, with reference to FIG. 3, test command initiator **304** may cause one of communicators **314** to transmit the test command to one of source media device(s) **302B** in response to the determination that the source media device is not providing video content for display on one of sink media device(s) **302A**. In implementations, the transmission of a test command may be carried out in a similar manner as described above with respect to step **202** of FIG. 2.

(69) In this manner, testing communication with a source media device using a communication protocol may be performed when the source media device is not in use, is in a sleep or other similar non-activity state, or powered off. As a result, automatic testing of commands may be conducted automatically in the background (i.e., with little to no user involvement) and/or without disruption to the user.

(70) It is noted, however, that the testing techniques described herein need not be performed in the background and/or without user involvement. For instance, in some other implementations, testing communication between multimedia receiver **104** and one or more source media device(s) **302B** may be initiated in response to an explicit user action, such as a user interaction with an interface of multimedia receiver **104** to perform one or more automatic control tests as described.

(71) Automatic control testing logic **114** may be configured to transmit test commands to one or more source media device(s) **302B** using one or more communication protocols to verify whether the device successfully received the command in other ways. In some examples, test command initiator **304** may be configured to initiate an automatic control test in accordance with implementations described herein during a configuration phase. For instance, test command initiator **304** may cause one of communicators **314** to transmit a test command to control a source media device during a configuration procedure of multimedia receiver **104**. Such a configuration procedure may comprise an initial configuration procedure (e.g., at the first boot-up of multimedia receiver **104**), a periodic configuration procedure (e.g., each day, week, month, etc., or based on any other periodic maintenance schedule), and/or in response to a user-initiated configuration procedure of multimedia receiver **104**.

(72) In some other implementations, test command initiator **304** may also initiate an automatic control test based on other factors, such as a network change (e.g., where an IP address of multimedia receiver **104** and/or a particular source media device changed since the device control mapping **120** was last updated). In another example, test command initiator **304** may initiate an automatic control test automatically in response to a determination that one or more sink media device(s) or source media device(s) was connected and/or disconnected from multimedia receiver **104**. In this manner, automatic control testing logic **114** may be configured to perform testing of communications with devices to ensure that device control mapping **120** remains up to date.

(73) It is also noted that in some further implementations, automatic control testing need not be performed in some instances where a configuration of a user's home entertainment has changed. For instance, if an IP address of a source media device changed since the last time device control mapping **120** was updated, instead of performing a control test as described herein to test IP-based controls with the source media device, network browser **312** may be configured to automatically identify the source media device's new IP address corresponding to a MAC address (or other device identifier) that may also be stored in device control mapping **120**. In some other instances, such as where a source media device's logical address changes during an HDMI-CEC negotiation between the media device and multimedia receiver **104**, device control mapping **120** may also be similarly configured to store an updated logical address automatically

without further control testing, enabling the mapping to be continuously updated.

(74) In accordance with example embodiments, determining whether a source media device received a test command based at least on a video frame may be performed in a variety of ways. For example, FIG. 5 is a flowchart of a method for determining whether a source media device received a test command based on a video frame, according to an example embodiment. For illustrative purposes, FIG. 5 will be described with continued reference to systems **100** and **300** of FIGS. 1 and 3, respectively. Other structural and operational embodiments will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) based on the discussion regarding flowchart **500** and the systems of FIGS. 1 and 3. Flowchart **500** and systems **100** and **300** are described in further detail as follows.

(75) In step **502**, a portion of the video frame may be compared with a portion of a previously obtained video frame. For instance, with reference to FIG. 3, test command verifier **308** may be configured to compare a video frame obtained by video frame capturer **306**, or a portion thereof, with a video frame (or portion of a video frame) previously obtained by video frame capturer **306**. Based on the comparison, test command verifier **308** may determine whether a change occurred in the video frame. If no change was observed based on the comparison of the video frames, test command verifier **308** may determine that the test command was not received or successfully applied by the source media device.

(76) If a change was observed based on the comparison, test command verifier **308** may determine whether the change was a result of the test command being applied to the source media device. In one illustrative example, if a test command comprised an operation to navigate to a particular element or screen, test command verifier **308** may analyze the video frame to determine whether such navigation was carried out in the obtained video frame when compared to the previously captured video frame. In some instances, test command verifier **308** may obtain and compare a plurality of video screens to determine whether a test command was carried out (e.g., by comparing the location of a cursor or selected icon on the video frame on successive video frames to determine whether a navigation operation consistent with the transmitted command has taken place).

(77) This is only one illustrative example, as test command verifier **308** may utilize other techniques as well. For instance, in other examples, test command verifier **308** may determine whether a particular screen or interface has been launched on a source media device in response to transmitting the test command to the device. For instance, if the transmitted test command comprised an operation to navigate to a home screen, menu screen, guide screen, launch a particular application or content, or carry out any other GUI function, test command verifier **308** may compare the obtained video frame with a previously captured frame from the same device to determine whether operation was carried out as expected based on the test command.

(78) In step **504**, a portion of the video frame may be compared with an expected image. For instance, with reference to FIG. 3, test command verifier **308** may compare a video frame obtained by video frame capturer **306** with an expected image (e.g., a predetermined image, icon, etc.). In one illustrative example, if a particular application or content is launched, test command verifier **308** may compare, using any one or more image analysis techniques known to those skilled in the relevant arts, an image obtained by video frame capturer **306** with an expected image stored in a repository of multimedia receiver **104** or stored in a remotely-accessible repository (e.g., in the cloud) accessible via network interface **116**. The expected image may comprise, for instance, a logo or other known representation of a device that may be expected to be present on a video frame upon transmitting a test command (e.g., a test command to launch a guide). In some examples, test command verifier **308** may compare only a portion of a video frame (e.g., an upper left corner where a logo is expected to be present) with an expected image to further conserve processing resources, although implementations are not limited to this example.

(79) For instance, in other examples, test command verifier **308** may compare a larger portion of

the video frame obtained by video frame capturer **306** (such as the entire video frame). In one illustrative example, such as where a test command comprised a command to cast an image transmitted to the source media device, test command verifier **308** may analyze the video frame to determine whether the casted image corresponding to the test command is present on the video frame. If test command verifier **308** determines that the obtained image matches the expected image (either completely or based on a similarity threshold), or is otherwise consistent with the expected image, test command verifier **308** may determine that the command was received and applied successfully.

(80) In step **506**, optical character recognition (OCR) may be performed on at least a portion of the video frame. For instance, with reference to FIG. **3**, test command verifier **308** may be configured to perform one or more OCR techniques on a video frame, or a portion thereof, to determine whether a test command was received by a source media device. In examples, test command verifier **308** may perform one or more OCR operations to determine whether a home, menu, or guide screen is present in a video frame obtained by video frame capturer **306** based on the transmitted test command. In some further examples, test command verifier **308** may perform an OCR operation only for a portion of a video frame where certain GUI elements are expected to be present (e.g., a left-hand side of a screen that may comprise a tree-view of a settings menu, an upper portion of a screen where a device logo that contains text may be present when a guide is launched, etc.). Test command verifier **308** may implement any one or more OCR techniques on a video frame or a portion thereof known and appreciated to those skilled in the relevant arts.

(81) It is noted and understood that test command verifier **308** is not limited to determining whether a source media device received a test command based at least on a video frame using the above techniques. Test command verifier **308** may make such a determination in any other manner, including, but not limited to, any combination of one or more of the above techniques or other techniques not expressly described.

(82) As described earlier, implementations may enable a multimedia receiver to test communications with a device to identify which devices are coupled to the multimedia receiver. In an example, a local area network (e.g., an IP-based network) or a peer-to-peer network (e.g., a Bluetooth™ network) may comprise one or more media devices, only one of which may be coupled to multimedia receiver **104**. In such an example, multimedia receiver **104** may implement techniques described herein to identify the particular media device among the plurality of media devices. For instance, FIG. **6** depicts a flowchart **600** of an example method for transmitting test commands to one or more devices available on a network, according to an example embodiment. The method of flowchart **600** will now be described with continued reference to the system of FIGS. **1** and **3**, although the method is not limited to those implementations. Other structural and operational embodiments will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) based on the discussion regarding flowchart **600** and the system of FIGS. **1** and **3**.

(83) Flowchart **600** begins with step **602**. In step **602**, one or more source media devices available on a network are identified. For instance, with reference to FIG. **3**, network browser **312** may be configured to browse a network to which multimedia receiver **104** may be coupled where one or more source media devices are available. In examples, network browser **312** may be configured to browse a local area network and/or a peer-to-peer network to identify such devices. In some instances, network browser **312** may identify an IP address, a MAC address, a device name, a device alias, etc. of each device available on the network.

(84) In the case of a local area network, network browser **312** may utilize one or more network discovery techniques to identify one or more devices available on the network (which may include one or more subnets). For instance, network browser **312** may cause network interface **116** to ping each identified device (e.g., via a brute-force technique) on the network to obtain information regarding the device identity, such as a type of device, an identifier of the device, a brand, etc. In some examples, network browser **312** may be configured to determine whether the identified

device is a type that may be potentially controllable via an IP-based command, such as a Roku® streaming media player.

(85) In some other instances, network browser **312** may implement a discovery scheme that is configured to broadcast information in accordance with one or more network protocols, such as Simple Service Discovery Protocol (SSDP), Session Description Protocol (SDP), Domain Name Service (DNS) discovery protocols, and/or DLNA-based protocols to obtain information regarding devices on the network. For instance, in response to one or more of such broadcasts on the network, one or more of the devices available on the network may respond with identifying information or other details regarding the responding device, such as a name, brand, make, model, IP address, MAC address, etc. of the responding device.

(86) Based on the received information for each device coupled to the local area network, network browser **312** may determine which of the devices are media devices that may potentially be controllable via commands transmitted over the network. For example, multimedia receiver **104** may comprise a listing (or obtain such a listing from a remote source) identifying which media devices support IP-based controls and therefore may potentially be controllable via IP commands. Furthermore, multimedia receiver **104** may be configured to automatically identify which devices may be coupled to multimedia receiver (e.g., by identifying a brand, make, model, etc. of the device). In this manner, network browser **312** may be enabled to filter all of the devices identified as being available on the network to determine which subset of devices it should attempt to test for IP-based controls. For instance, if a particular household has multiple Roku® devices available on the home network to which multimedia receiver **104** is also coupled, a filter may be used to identify all such Roku® devices in a from the list of devices available on the network.

(87) In an example involving a peer-to-peer network, such as a Bluetooth™ network, network browser **312** may be configured to automatically identify all of the discoverable devices within a nearby vicinity of multimedia receiver **104** that may potentially match a device coupled to multimedia receiver **104** (e.g., based on an automatically determined device name, brand, etc.) and/or automatically pair with each such device. An example implementation in which automatic pairing may be carried out using techniques explained herein is described in greater detail below with respect to FIG. 7.

(88) In step **604**, for each of the one or more source media devices, a corresponding test command is transmitted over the network to control the source media device. For instance, with reference to FIG. 3, test command initiator **304** may cause IP controller **316** (in the case of a local area network) and/or RF controller **318** (in the case of a peer-to-peer network) to transmit a test command to each of the source media devices identified as being available on the network. Test commands may include any of the commands as described herein, including but not limited to navigation commands, commands to launch certain screens, interfaces, or content, or commands to cast an image or video for presentation on a sink media device. Additional examples of such test commands are described above with respect to step **202** of FIG. 2.

(89) In some instances, where a plurality of media devices is located on the network (on a local area network or in a short-range peer-to-peer network), test command initiator **304** may be configured to transmit unique commands to each device identified as being available on the network. In an illustrative example, a network may have four Roku® devices, only one of which is coupled to multimedia receiver **104**. A unique test command may be transmitted to each of the four Roku® devices using network interface **116**. For instance, test command initiator **304** may cause IP controller **316** to transmit a test command using network interface **116** to a first one of the devices to carry out a first action (e.g., navigate to a first screen such as a guide screen, launch a first application, search for a first item of multimedia content, launch a first item of multimedia content, or any other action that may be carried out through a test command described herein). Test command initiator **304** may transmit a different test command to a second device to carry out a different action (e.g., navigate to a second screen such as a home screen, launch a second

application, search for a second item of multimedia content, launch a second item of multimedia content, etc.). Test command initiator **304** may similarly transmit different test commands to the third and fourth devices as well.

(90) In another illustration, the test command transmitted to each source media device(s) **302B** available on the network may comprise a command to cast a unique image, video, or audio signal for presentation on one of sink media device(s) **302A**. For instance, test command initiator **304** may transmit, to the first source media device, an image with a unique number, letter, barcode, or other representation for casting to a sink device. Test command initiator **304** may transmit a different image (e.g., with a different unique number, letter, barcode, or other unique representation) for casting to a sink device. In this manner, test command initiator **304** may be configured to transmit a test command to each source media device available on a network to cast different content for casting on a sink device.

(91) It is noted and understood that the above examples are illustrative only, and any unique test command may be transmitted to each device available on the network. In addition, any number and combination of test commands may be transmitted to each device identified as being available on the network. Furthermore, in some instances, the test command may also comprise a sequence of commands that are uniquely transmitted to each device, such as navigating a GUI to a search page, inputting a search phrase (e.g., inserting text to search for a particular movie, and launching the movie). In other words, instead of a test command comprising a single operation, test command initiator **304** may transmit a sequence of test commands, such that if the commands are verified as being received successfully, a wider variety of individual commands may be inferred as being operable to control the device using the tested communication protocol.

(92) In step **606**, a video frame output by one of the one or more source media devices is obtained. For instance, with reference to FIG. 3, video frame capturer **306** may be configured to obtain a video frame from one of the one or more source media devices coupled to multimedia receiver **104**. In other words, while network browser **312** may identify a plurality of a particular type of IP-controllable devices available on a network (e.g., Roku® devices in an earlier illustration), only one of those devices may be physically coupled to multimedia receiver **104**, while the remaining devices may be coupled to other systems and/or sink devices. As a result, since only one of the devices may be coupled to multimedia receiver **104**, video frame capturer **306** may be configured to receive a video frame from only one of source media device(s) **302B** to which one of the unique commands was transmitted.

(93) In implementations, step **606** may otherwise be performed in a similar manner as described above with respect to step **204** of FIG. 2. For instance, multimedia receiver **104** may obtain a video frame from one of port(s) **110** coupled to a particular one of source media device(s) to which a test command was transmitted. In examples, since automatic control testing logic **114** may not know which of the devices identified as being available on the network are coupled to multimedia receiver **104**, video frame capturer **306** may be configured to obtain a video frame from a plurality of port(s) **110** to which one of the devices may be coupled.

(94) In step **608**, it is determined that one of the one or more source media devices received the corresponding test command based at least on the video frame. In examples, step **608** may be performed in a similar manner as described above with respect to step **206** of FIG. 2 and/or according to flowchart **500** of FIG. 5. For instance, test command verifier **308** may be configured to analyze a video frame to determine whether a video frame obtained by video frame capturer **306** is consistent with a test command transmitted to the device.

(95) It is noted, however, that in some implementation described in FIG. 6, such as where a plurality of unique test commands may be transmitted to a plurality of devices available on a network, test command verifier **308** may analyze the obtained video frame with respect to each of the unique test commands to determine if the video frame corresponds to any of the unique commands. For instance, the test command for a first device comprised a command to launch a

guide screen, the test command for a second device comprised a command to launch a particular movie, and the test command for a third device comprised a command to launch a menu screen. In such an illustrative example, if the video frame obtained from the source media device coupled to multimedia receiver **104** indicated that the particular movie was launched, test command verifier **308** may thereby determine that the coupled source media device corresponds to the device to which a test command to launch the movie was transmitted.

(96) In some implementations, an identifier of the media device coupled to multimedia receiver **104** may also be determined. For instance, as discussed above, test command verifier **308** may analyze the one or more obtained video frames to determine whether any of the video frames corresponds to one of the test commands (e.g., navigating to a particular screen or interface, launching a particular application, casting a certain image, etc.). Based on such a determination that an obtained video frame corresponds to a particular test command, an identifier of the device coupled to multimedia receiver **104** may be determined. For instance, because test commands may be transmitted to each of the devices using a network address discovered when browsing a network, determining that a test command was successfully received by a particular device may thereby indicate the network address of the device that successfully received the test command (i.e., the source media device coupled to multimedia receiver **104**). In implementations, the identifier of the media device may comprise a network identifier, such as an IP address, a MAC address, a device name, a device alias, etc. of the device.

(97) In this manner, not only may test command verifier **308** be configured to identify which device, from among a plurality of devices available on a network, is coupled to multimedia receiver **104**, test command verifier **308** may also be configured to determine that the coupled media device successfully received an IP-based test command (or a sequence of IP-based commands). In some implementations, once an identifier (such as an IP address) is determined, automatic control testing logic **114** may be configured to further transmit additional test commands to the source media device (using the identified IP address) to verify control of the device using the network (e.g., by testing a plurality of different command types).

(98) In step **610**, in response to determining that the one of the one or more source media devices received the test command, a device identifier and an indication that the one of the one or more source media devices can be controlled over the network is stored. For instance, with reference to FIG. **3**, test command verifier **308** may store, in device control mapping **120**, the identifier (e.g., network address(s) or the like) of the media device as well as an indication that the media device may be controlled over the network. In implementations, the stored identifier (e.g., network address(s)) may be used by multimedia receiver **104** for a variety of purposes, such as for further control testing of the media device (e.g., transmitting additional test commands to the device using the IP address identified as belong to the device coupled to the multimedia receiver), and/or to appropriately transmit commands to control the media device during operation (e.g., based on a user-input to control the device to carry out certain actions. It is noted that device control mapping **120** may also store, for the media device, an indication that the device may be controlled using any other communication protocol (e.g., RF, IR, HDMI-CEC, etc.) as described herein.

(99) It is also noted that in some other implementations, a network address may be automatically discovered in other ways. For instance, where other communication protocols have been tested to work with a particular one of source media device(s) **302B**, test command initiator **304** may be configured to transmit a series of commands for application on the source media device using any of the tested communication protocols (e.g., IR, RF, and/or HDMI-CEC) to navigate the media device to a settings or status menu option in which the network address of the source media device may be obtained by automatic control testing logic **114** (e.g., by performing an OCR operation on a video frame containing the network address).

(100) As a result, instead of prompting a user to identify a network address of a coupled device, which can be cumbersome and difficult to locate and input in some scenarios, automatic control

testing logic **114** may automatically determine the network address of a coupled device, while also testing communication with the device using the network address with little to no user involvement.

(101) As described earlier, implementations may enable a multimedia receiver to test communications a device over a peer-to-peer network. For instance, FIG. 7 depicts a flowchart **600** of an example method for automatically pairing with a media device, according to an example embodiment. The method of flowchart **700** will now be described with continued reference to the system of FIGS. 1 and 3, although the method is not limited to those implementations. Other structural and operational embodiments will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) based on the discussion regarding flowchart **700** and the system of FIGS. 1 and 3.

(102) Flowchart **700** begins with step **702**. In step **702**, an automatic pairing may be carried out with at least one of the one or more media devices using the peer-to-peer wireless network. For instance, with reference to FIG. 3, RF controller **318** may cause RF transmitter **126** to automatically connect or pair to one or more of source media device(s) **302B**, or may connect or pair to such devices manually (e.g., via a user interaction). For example, network browser **312** may be configured to automatically identify Bluetooth™ discoverable devices in the vicinity of multimedia receiver **104** and cause RF controller **318** to pair to one or more source media device(s) **302B** where a pairing pin is not required (e.g., in an open-pairing configuration), or may be configured to automatically attempt to pair with the device using one or more commonly used pairing pins (e.g., 0000 or 1234). In examples, such a pain may be transmitted via one or more communication protocols described, including via RF controller **318** (e.g., via a Bluetooth™ communication protocol).

(103) In other instances, such as where a non-standard pin is required for pairing, test command initiator **304** may be configured to automatically transmit one or more commands to the source media device for which pairing is being attempted to navigate the device using another communication protocol (e.g., IR, HDMI-CEC, and/or IP). For instance, test command initiator **304** may navigate the source media device in a certain manner to launch a home or menu screen, launch a settings option, navigate to a Bluetooth™ settings page, make the source media “discoverable” for pairing, etc. Such navigation may be performed automatically based on analyzing the screen content of the source media device, and/or based on prior knowledge of a particular device's GUI arrangement. In some implementation, such as where the pin is presented by one of source media device(s) **302B**, RF controller **318** may be configured to utilize the displayed pin based on an obtained video frame (e.g., via OCR or other suitable technique) to complete the pairing process. In other examples, such as where multimedia receiver **104** generates the pin required for pairing, RF controller **318** may be configured to cause the generated pin to be input into the appropriate GUI element of the source media device upon navigation using one or more of the communication protocols described herein.

(104) It is noted that once automatic pairing is performed, automatic control testing logic **114** may be configured to transmit one or more test commands (e.g., navigation commands, launching of content, inputting text, etc.) to the source media device via RF controller **318** to verify that the source media device is controllable via the peer-to-peer network. As a result, automatic control testing logic **114** may be configured to automatically pair with a Bluetooth™ capable device and optionally perform additional communication testing with little to no user involvement.

IV. Further Example Embodiments and Advantages

(105) One or more embodiments described herein may perform their functions according to the flowcharts described herein. Additional structural and operational embodiments will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) based on the discussions regarding the flowcharts and embodiments herein. In some example embodiments, one or more of the steps of the described flowcharts may not be performed. Moreover, steps in addition to or in lieu of the steps of the described flowcharts may be performed (some of which were described above). Further, in some

example embodiments, one or more of the steps of the described flowcharts may be performed out of the order shown or described, in an alternate sequence, and/or partially (or completely) concurrently with other steps.

(106) The automatic control testing embodiments and/or any further systems, sub-systems, devices and/or components disclosed herein may be implemented in hardware (e.g., hardware logic/electrical circuitry), or any combination of hardware with software (computer program code configured to be executed in one or more processors or processing devices) and/or firmware.

(107) The embodiments described herein, including systems, methods/processes, devices, and/or apparatuses, may be implemented using well known processing devices, telephones (smart phones and/or mobile phones), tablet computers, servers, and/or, computers, such as a computer **800** shown in FIG. **8**. It should be noted that computer **800** may represent communication devices, processing devices, servers, and/or traditional computers in one or more embodiments. For example, the automatic control testing embodiments, and any of the sub-systems or components respectively contained therein, may be implemented using one or more computers **800** or portions thereof. For example, the source media device(s), the sink media device(s), and/or the multimedia receiver, of FIGS. **1** and **3**, and/or the components included therein, and each of the steps of flowchart **200**, **400**, **500**, **600**, and **700** can each be implemented using one or more computers **800**.

(108) Computer **800** can be any commercially available and well-known communication device, processing device, and/or computer capable of performing the functions described herein, such as devices/computers available from International Business Machines®, Apple®, Sun®, HP®, Dell®, Cray®, Samsung®, Nokia®, etc. Computer **800** may be any type of computer, including a desktop computer, a server, etc.

(109) Computer **800** includes one or more processors (also called central processing units, or CPUs), such as a processor **806**. Processor **806** may include the source media device(s), the sink media device(s), and/or the multimedia receiver, of FIGS. **1** and **3**, and/or the components included therein, for example, though the scope of the embodiments is not limited in this respect. Processor **806** is connected to a communication infrastructure **802**, such as a communication bus. In some embodiments, processor **806** can simultaneously operate multiple computing threads.

(110) Computer **800** also includes a primary or main memory **808**, such as random-access memory (RAM). Main memory **808** has stored therein control logic **824** (computer software), and data.

(111) Computer **800** also includes one or more secondary storage devices **810**. Secondary storage devices **810** include, for example, a hard disk drive **812** and/or a removable storage device or drive **814**, as well as other types of storage devices, such as memory cards and memory sticks. For instance, computer **800** may include an industry standard interface, such a universal serial bus (USB) interface for interfacing with devices such as a memory stick. Removable storage drive **814** represents a floppy disk drive, a magnetic tape drive, a compact disk drive, an optical storage device, tape backup, etc.

(112) Removable storage drive **814** interacts with a removable storage unit **816**. Removable storage unit **816** includes a computer useable or readable storage medium **818** having stored therein computer software **826** (control logic) and/or data. Removable storage unit **816** represents a floppy disk, magnetic tape, compact disk, DVD, optical storage disk, or any other computer data storage device. Removable storage drive **814** reads from and/or writes to removable storage unit **816** in a well-known manner.

(113) Removable storage drive **814** interacts with a removable storage unit **816**. Removable storage unit **816** includes a computer useable or readable storage medium **818** having stored therein computer software **826** (control logic) and/or data. Removable storage unit **816** represents a floppy disk, magnetic tape, compact disc (CD), digital versatile disc (DVD), Blu-ray™ disc, optical storage disk, memory stick, memory card, or any other computer data storage device. Removable storage drive **814** reads from and/or writes to removable storage unit **816** in a well-known manner.

(114) Computer **800** also includes input/output/display devices **804**, such as touchscreens, LED and

LCD displays, monitors, keyboards, pointing devices, etc.

(115) Computer **800** further includes a communication or network interface **818**. Communication interface **820** enables computer **800** to communicate with remote devices. For example, communication interface **820** allows computer **800** to communicate over communication networks or mediums **822** (representing a form of a computer useable or readable medium), such as local area networks (LANs), wide area networks (WANs), the Internet, etc. Network interface **820** may interface with remote sites or networks via wired or wireless connections. Examples of communication interface **822** include but are not limited to a modem, a network interface card (e.g., an Ethernet card), a communication port, a Personal Computer Memory Card International Association (PCMCIA) card, etc.

(116) Control logic **828** may be transmitted to and from computer **800** via the communication medium **822**.

(117) Any apparatus or manufacture comprising a computer useable or readable medium having control logic (software) stored therein is referred to herein as a computer program product or program storage device. This includes, but is not limited to, computer **800**, main memory **808**, secondary storage devices **810**, and removable storage unit **816**. Such computer program products, having control logic stored therein that, when executed by one or more data processing devices, cause such data processing devices to operate as described herein, represent example embodiments described herein.

(118) Techniques, including methods, and embodiments described herein may be implemented by hardware (digital and/or analog) or a combination of hardware with one or both of software and/or firmware. Techniques described herein may be implemented by one or more components.

Embodiments may comprise computer program products comprising logic (e.g., in the form of program code or software as well as firmware) stored on any computer useable medium, which may be integrated in or separate from other components. Such program code, when executed by one or more processor circuits, causes a device to operate as described herein. Devices in which embodiments may be implemented may include storage, such as storage drives, memory devices, and further types of physical hardware computer-readable storage media. Examples of such computer-readable storage media include, a hard disk, a removable magnetic disk, a removable optical disk, flash memory cards, digital video disks, random access memories (RAMs), read only memories (ROM), and other types of physical hardware storage media. In greater detail, examples of such computer-readable storage media include, but are not limited to, a hard disk associated with a hard disk drive, a removable magnetic disk, a removable optical disk (e.g., CDROMs, DVDs, etc.), zip disks, tapes, magnetic storage devices, MEMS (micro-electromechanical systems) storage, nanotechnology-based storage devices, flash memory cards, digital video discs, RAM devices, ROM devices, and further types of physical hardware storage media. Such computer-readable storage media may, for example, store computer program logic, e.g., program modules, comprising computer executable instructions that, when executed by one or more processor circuits, provide and/or maintain one or more aspects of functionality described herein with reference to the figures, as well as any and all components, capabilities, and functions therein and/or further embodiments described herein. Embodiments described herein are directed to computer program products comprising such logic (e.g., in the form of program code, instructions, or software) stored on any computer useable medium. Such program code, when executed in one or more processors, causes a device to operate as described herein

(119) Such computer-readable storage media are distinguished from and non-overlapping with communication media (do not include communication media). Communication media embodies computer-readable instructions, data structures, program modules or other data in a modulated data signal such as a carrier wave. The term “modulated data signal” means a signal that has one or more of its characteristics set or changed in such a manner as to encode information in the signal. By way of example, and not limitation, communication media includes wireless media such as

acoustic, RF, IR, and other wireless media, as well as wired media and signals transmitted over wired media. Embodiments are also directed to such communication media.

(120) The techniques and embodiments described herein may be implemented as, or in, various types of devices. For instance, embodiments may be included, without limitation, in processing devices (e.g., illustrated in FIG. 8) such as computers and servers, as well as communication systems such as switches, routers, gateways, and/or the like, communication devices such as smart phones, home electronics, gaming consoles, entertainment devices/systems, etc. A device, as defined herein, is a machine or manufacture as defined by 35 U.S.C. § 101. That is, as used herein, the term “device” refers to a machine or other tangible, manufactured object and excludes software and signals. Devices may include digital circuits, analog circuits, or a combination thereof. Devices may include one or more processor circuits (e.g., central processing units (CPUs), processor 806 of FIG. 8), microprocessors, digital signal processors (DSPs), and further types of physical hardware processor circuits) and/or may be implemented with any semiconductor technology in a semiconductor material, including one or more of a Bipolar Junction Transistor (BJT), a heterojunction bipolar transistor (HBT), a metal oxide field effect transistor (MOSFET) device, a metal semiconductor field effect transistor (MESFET) or other transistor or transistor technology device. Such devices may use the same or alternative configurations other than the configuration illustrated in embodiments presented herein.

(121) It is noted that while FIG. 8 shows a server/computer, persons skilled in the relevant art(s) would understand that embodiments/features described herein could also be implemented using other well-known processor-based computing devices, including but not limited to, smart phones, tablet computers, netbooks, gaming consoles, personal media players, and the like.

V. Conclusion

(122) While various embodiments have been described above, it should be understood that they have been presented by way of example only, and not limitation. It will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art that various changes in form and detail can be made therein without departing from the spirit and scope of the embodiments. Thus, the breadth and scope of the embodiments should not be limited by any of the above-described exemplary embodiments, but should be defined only in accordance with the following claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. A mobile control device, comprising: at least one wireless interface; one or more processors; and one or more memory devices that store program code configured to be executed by the one or more processors, the program code comprising instructions, when executed by the one or more processors, cause the mobile control device to: automatically identify, by the mobile control device, at least one other device communicatively coupled to the mobile control device; obtain, by the mobile control device, a device control mapping for the identified at least one other device from a remote system, wherein the device control mapping comprises an indication that the identified at least one other device successfully received and applied a test command, wherein the indication indicates that the identified at least one other device is controllable by the mobile control device; store, at the mobile control device, the device control mapping for the identified at least one other device obtained from the remote system; and communicate, by the mobile control device, at least one command through the wireless interface to control the operation of the identified at least one other device based on the stored device control mapping, wherein the at least one command includes a voice command.

2. The mobile control device of claim 1, wherein the at least one other device is identified by at least one of name, brand, make, model, Internet Protocol (IP) address, or Media Access Control (MAC) address.

3. The mobile control device of claim 1, wherein the at least one wireless interface comprises a Wi-

Fi or Bluetooth interface.

4. The mobile control device of claim 1, wherein the at least one other device is a television.

5. The mobile control device of claim 1, wherein the instructions, when executed by the one or more processors, further cause the mobile control device to: pair with the identified at least one other device using a pin or identifier.

6. The mobile control device of claim 5, wherein the pairing is accomplished using Bluetooth or Wi-Fi.

7. The mobile control device of claim 1, wherein the identified at least one other device is a sink device.

8. The mobile control device of claim 7, wherein the sink device has a plurality of audio/video (AV) ports.

9. The mobile control device of claim 8, wherein at least one of the plurality of AV ports is a High-Definition Multimedia Interface (HDMI) port that supports High-Definition Multimedia Interface Consumer Electronics Control (HDMI-CEC).

10. The mobile control device of claim 8, wherein the sink device has control logic configured to: receive a command from the mobile control device; and in response to receiving the command from the mobile control device, provide a control signal to a switch circuit of the sink device that causes the switch circuit to switch to an active AV port of the plurality of AV ports of the sink device.

11. A method for automatically configuring a mobile control device, the method comprising: automatically identifying, by the mobile control device, at least one other device communicatively coupled to the mobile control device, the mobile control device having at least one wireless interface; obtaining, by the mobile control device, a device control mapping for the identified at least one other device from a remote system, wherein the device control mapping comprises an indication that the at least one other device successfully received and applied a test command, wherein the indication indicates that the identified at least one other device is controllable by the mobile control device; storing, at the mobile control device, the device control mapping for the identified at least one other device obtained from the remote system; and communicating, by the mobile control device, at least one command through the wireless interface to control the operation of the identified at least one other device based on the stored device control mapping, wherein the at least one command includes a voice command.

12. The method of claim 11, wherein the at least one other device is identified by at least one of name, brand, make, model, Internet Protocol (IP) address, or Media Access Control (MAC) address.

13. The method of claim 11, further comprising: pairing with the identified at least one other device using a pin or identifier.

14. The method of claim 13, wherein the pairing is accomplished using Bluetooth or Wi-Fi.

15. The method of claim 11, wherein the at least one other device is a sink device.

16. The method of claim 15, wherein the sink device has a plurality of audio/video (AV) ports.

17. The method of claim 16, wherein at least one of the plurality of AV ports is a High-Definition Multimedia Interface (HDMI) port that supports High-Definition Multimedia Interface Consumer Electronics Control (HDMI-CEC).

18. A non-transitory computer-readable storage medium having program logic recorded thereon that, when executed by at least one processor circuit, perform a method, the method comprising: automatically identifying, by a mobile control device, at least one other device communicatively coupled to the mobile control device, the mobile control device having at least one wireless interface; obtaining, by the mobile control device, a device control mapping for the identified at least one other device from a remote system, wherein the device control mapping comprises an indication that the identified at least one other device successfully received and applied a test command, wherein the indication indicates that the identified at least one other device is

controllable by the mobile control device; storing, at the mobile control device, the device control mapping for the identified at least one other device obtained from the remote system; and communicating, by the mobile control device, at least one command through the wireless interface to control the operation of the at least one other device based on the stored device control mapping, wherein the identified at least one command includes a voice command.

19. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 18, wherein the at least one other device is identified by at least one of name, brand, make, model, Internet Protocol (IP) address, or Media Access Control (MAC) address.

20. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 18, wherein the method further comprises: pairing with the identified at least one other device using a pin or identifier.
